

INITIAL LANGUAGE EVALUATION REPORT

Solène PICOT

Written Communication (approx. 4 hours)

Field	Details
Candidate	Solène PICOT
Email	picots@hec.fr
Department	Ressources Humaines
Job Title	Chargée de formation
Written Test Date	22 June 2026
Oral Assessment Date	29 June 2026
Evaluator	Hannah DURRANT

1. Executive Summary

Solène PICOT completed both a written placement test and an oral assessment with Linguaid France in June 2026. The combined evaluation paints a consistent picture of a motivated candidate with a solid but developing foundation in English, operating at the **B1 (2)** level in written skills and at a lower **A2-A2+ (1-1.5)** level in oral production and comprehension.

Her written profile demonstrates reliable control of basic tenses, clear communicative intent, and growing exposure to professional vocabulary. Her oral profile, however, reveals a more significant gap: comprehension in live interaction is effortful, spoken production is hesitant, and her current level of spoken English limits her ability to participate confidently in the professional telephone calls and meetings that her role increasingly requires.

| Overall CEFR Profile

Skill	CEFR Level	Linguaid Band
Grammar	B1	2
Writing	B1	2
Reading / Vocabulary	B1	2
Listening	A2+	1.5
Speaking	A2	1
Overall Combined Level	A2+-B1	1.5-2

The gap between Solène's written and oral skills is notable and should be a primary driver of her training programme. She is well placed to make meaningful progress, particularly given her strong intrinsic motivation and the highly concrete professional context that will anchor her learning throughout.

2. Skill-by-Skill Assessment

| 2.1 Grammar

Level: B1 (2)

Strengths

- Consistent and accurate use of the **present simple** for facts, routines, and professional descriptions
- Reliable control of the **simple past** across both regular and irregular verb forms
- Correct application of the **present continuous** as a tense form (structural accuracy, even where lexical errors occur around it)
- Functional use of the **"want to + infinitive"** construction for expressing future intentions
- Accurate basic negation

Development Areas

- **Passive voice:** entirely absent from written and spoken output; essential for professional and HR writing (e.g. *"training sessions are scheduled," "the decision was made"*)
- **Conditional structures:** no evidence of second conditional (*"If I were..., I would..."*) or third conditional; a critical gap for professional hypothetical and reflective communication
- **Future tense variety:** over-reliance on *"want to"*; needs to develop control of *"going to," "will,"* and present continuous for arrangements
- **Article usage:** recurring omission and incorrect insertion (e.g. *"the Human Resources," "the next year"*)
- **Complex clause construction:** sentences are predominantly simple or loosely coordinated; subordinate and relative clauses are not yet used
- **Discourse connectors:** limited to *"but"* and *"and"*; needs to develop *"however," "although," "as a result," "furthermore"*

| 2.2 Writing

Level: B1 (2)

Strengths

- Consistently **clear and easy to understand**; communicative intent is never lost
- Ideas are **sequenced logically** across all three free-writing responses
- Demonstrates emerging awareness of **professional register** and domain-relevant vocabulary (*"training officer," "master's degree," "international organization"*)
- Shows **genuine voice and motivation** in written responses, particularly when discussing professional ambitions

Development Areas

- **Syntactic variety**: sentences are short and predominantly simple; greater use of subordination would strengthen overall quality
- **Discourse cohesion**: transitions between ideas rely on full stops and basic conjunctions; a broader range of connectors is needed
- **Register control**: informal constructions (e.g. sentences beginning with *"But"*) appear where a more formal alternative would be appropriate
- **Descriptive and argumentative depth**: responses are functional but brief; elaboration and justification are limited
- **L1 interference**: French spelling (*"Ressources"*), false cognates (*"practice sports"*), and direct translation structures are present
- **Professional writing genres**: email structure, formal requests, and report-style writing are not yet developed

| 2.3 Reading and Vocabulary

Level: B1 (2)

Strengths

- **Functional lexical range** sufficient for everyday and introductory professional communication
- Accurate use of key professional terms relevant to her role: *"training officer," "master's degree," "international organization," "business school"*
- Receptive vocabulary appears adequate for general written professional content at this level

Development Areas

- **HR-specific vocabulary**: language for performance reviews, recruitment, onboarding, inter-departmental communication, and training coordination requires deliberate development

- **Collocations:** basic vocabulary choices dominate; natural professional collocations ("*build fluency*," "*enhance communication skills*," "*conduct an appraisal*") are not yet present in productive output
- **False cognates and L1 interference:** e.g. "*practice sports*" (from French *pratiquer*); these patterns will require explicit attention
- **Reading range:** exposure to authentic English professional documents — HR brochures, emails, meeting minutes — will be essential given the bilingual nature of her responsibilities at HEC

| 2.4 Listening

Level: A2+ (1.5)

Strengths

- Demonstrates a basic ability to follow **simple, clear spoken input** in familiar contexts
- Willingness to **seek clarification actively** when she does not understand — a valuable metacognitive habit that will support her development
- Responds appropriately when input is simplified or repeated

Development Areas

- **Comprehension in live interaction:** Solène struggled to follow the role-play scenario during the oral assessment; understanding spoken English at natural pace in an unfamiliar professional context is a significant current challenge
- **Telephone comprehension:** the absence of visual cues makes telephone interaction particularly demanding at this level; this is a high-priority area given her professional context
- **Extended listening:** following a meeting, a multi-turn exchange, or a set of spoken instructions without support is not yet reliably achievable
- **Processing speed:** there is a visible gap between hearing and understanding in real time, which places pressure on both interaction and spoken production

| 2.5 Speaking

Level: A2 (1)

Strengths

- **Motivated and willing to attempt communication** even under pressure; does not shut down when faced with difficulty

- Conveys basic personal and professional information when given sufficient time and support
- **Asks questions and signals non-understanding** — a genuine strength that reflects communicative confidence at this stage
- Shows awareness of what she wants to say, even when she cannot yet say it fluently

Development Areas

- **Fluency:** spoken production is hesitant and effortful; pauses are frequent and extended
- **Accuracy in speech:** grammatical structures available in writing are not yet reliably transferred to spoken production
- **Vocabulary activation:** receptive vocabulary is not yet accessible under the real-time pressures of live conversation
- **Pronunciation:** requires development for clarity and intelligibility in professional contexts, particularly on the telephone
- **Interaction management:** managing turn-taking, asking for clarification politely, and maintaining a conversation across multiple exchanges are all areas for development
- **Telephone communication:** currently the most vulnerable professional skill; Solène has indicated she sends emails specifically to avoid telephone calls — a pattern that reflects the real gap and that training should seek to address

3. Learning Objectives

The following three objectives have been defined in alignment with Solène's professional context, her validated goals, and the priority areas identified across both assessments.

- **Utiliser des formules standard pour rédiger des emails professionnels variés** afin de gérer les échanges écrits de façon autonome.
- **Comprendre et employer le vocabulaire RH essentiel à l'écrit et à l'oral** pour communiquer efficacement dans son environnement professionnel.
- **Participer à un appel téléphonique professionnel simple en anglais** afin de réduire sa dépendance à la communication écrite.

4. Training Plan

4.1 Programme Overview

Parameter	Detail
Current Level	A2+ (1.5) – B1 (2)
Target Level	B1 (2) consolidated across all skills
Total Hours	10 coaching hours
Format	Video call (visio)
Start Date	September 2026
Availability	Monday (morning & afternoon) / Wednesday (morning & afternoon)

4.2 Priority Content Areas

Given Solène's professional responsibilities — writing bilingual training brochures, sending emails to colleagues and external partners, managing occasional telephone queries, and coordinating with her manager at HEC — the following content areas are prioritised for the 10-hour programme:

- Professional email structure: opening formulas, stating purpose, providing information, closing
- Standard language for routine query types: information requests, confirmations, follow-ups, apologies
- Register awareness: formal vs. informal; appropriate tone for internal and external communication
- Bilingual brochure writing: clarity, precision, and professional vocabulary in context

Telephone and Spoken Interaction (approx. 3 hours)

- Telephone-specific language: greetings, identifying yourself, stating purpose, asking for repetition
- Clarification strategies: *"Could you repeat that?" "I'm sorry, I didn't catch that." "Could you spell that for me?"*
- Role-play practice: simulated calls based on real professional scenarios from Solène's context
- Listening tasks: short recorded telephone exchanges at A2+–B1 level

Grammar and Tense Development (approx. 2 hours)

- Future forms in context: *"going to," "will,"* present continuous for arrangements
- Simple past consolidation and extension: time adverbials, sequencing
- Present simple and continuous: professional descriptions, ongoing projects
- Introduction to passive voice: common professional contexts (*"training sessions are held," "emails are sent"*)

Vocabulary and Domain Knowledge (approx. 1 hour)

- Core HR vocabulary: training, onboarding, appraisal, recruitment, scheduling
- Professional collocations relevant to Solène's written and spoken output
- False cognate and L1 interference awareness

| 4.3 Scheduling Notes

- Programme to **begin in September 2026**
- Sessions to be held via **video call (visio)**
- Preferred slots: **Monday morning or afternoon / Wednesday morning or afternoon**
- Session length and frequency to be confirmed with the candidate and her manager at programme launch

5. Evaluator Narrative Summary

Solène PICOT presents as a thoughtful and professionally engaged candidate whose English profile reflects the specific demands and constraints of her academic and work context. She is currently completing a Master's degree in Human Resources as an apprentice at HEC Paris, a demanding dual commitment that shapes both her exposure to English and the urgency of her learning goals.

Her written profile is the more developed of the two. Across her free-writing responses, Solène demonstrates clear communicative intent, logical organisation, and the beginnings of a professional lexical range. She writes with purpose and without ambiguity, which is a meaningful achievement at this level. The structural limitations — absent passive voice, undeveloped future forms, no conditional structures, and limited discourse connectors — are entirely consistent with the B1 (2) placement and represent a coherent and addressable developmental roadmap rather than fragmented or unpredictable gaps.

Her oral profile tells a different story. During the oral assessment, Solène found the role-play scenario genuinely challenging to follow, and her spoken production under real-time pressure was hesitant and limited. This gap between written and spoken English is not uncommon among candidates whose primary professional exposure to English is through written channels — and Solène herself acknowledged that she often chooses to send an email rather than make a telephone call precisely because the spoken channel is more demanding. This is an honest and self-aware position, and it directly informs the priorities of her training programme.

What is notable — and what makes Solène a strong candidate for meaningful progress — is her attitude. She is visibly motivated, she asks questions when she does not understand, and she persists in attempting to communicate even when she is not certain. These are not trivial qualities. At A2-B1, the willingness to engage and to take communicative risks is one of the strongest predictors of progression, and Solène demonstrates both consistently.

Her professional context provides an unusually concrete and motivating anchor for her training. She works daily with English-speaking colleagues and collaborators, contributes to bilingual training brochures, and operates within an international academic environment. The gap between her current oral level and the communicative demands of her role is real — but it is also bridgeable within a well-structured 10-hour programme that keeps her actual professional tasks at the centre of every session.

The recommended focus on professional email writing, telephone interaction, core HR vocabulary, and tense development reflects both the evidence of the assessment and the practical priorities that Solène and her evaluator identified together. With consistent engagement and targeted practice, consolidation at B1 (2) across all skills — including a meaningful uplift in spoken confidence — is a realistic and achievable outcome.

6. Sign-Off

Evaluator	Hannah DURRANT
Organisation	Linguaid France
Written Test Date	22 June 2026
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